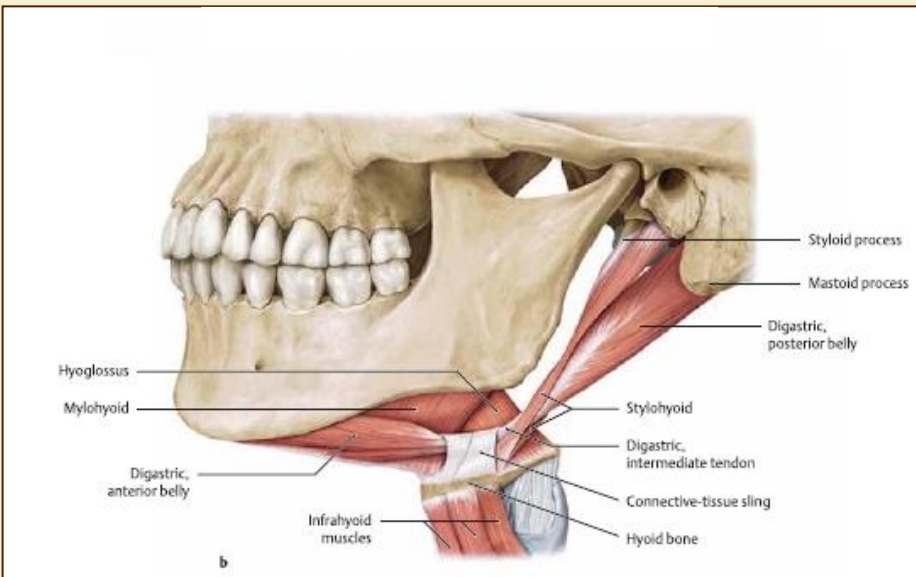
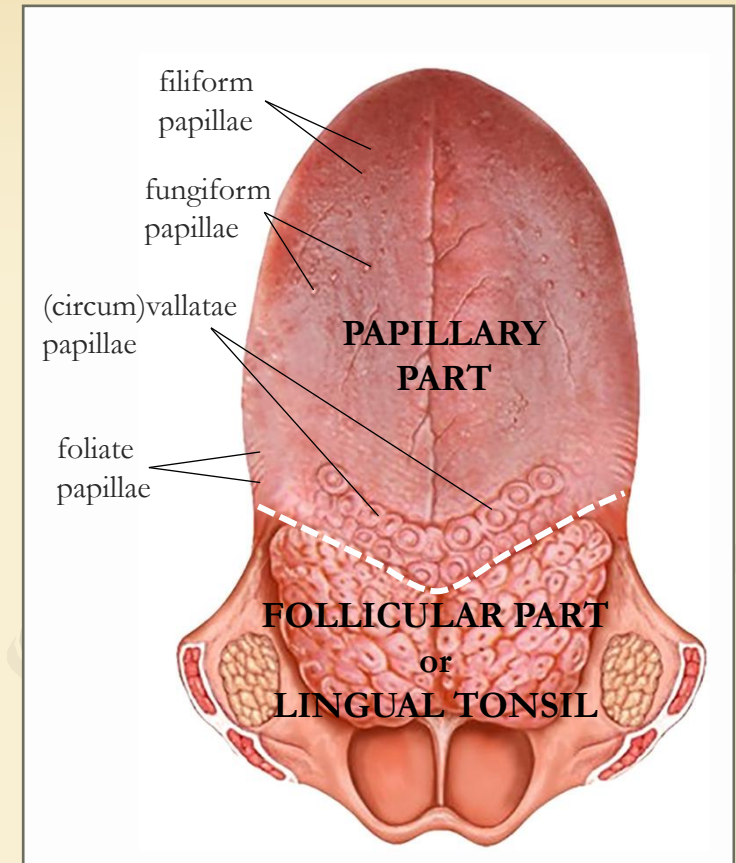
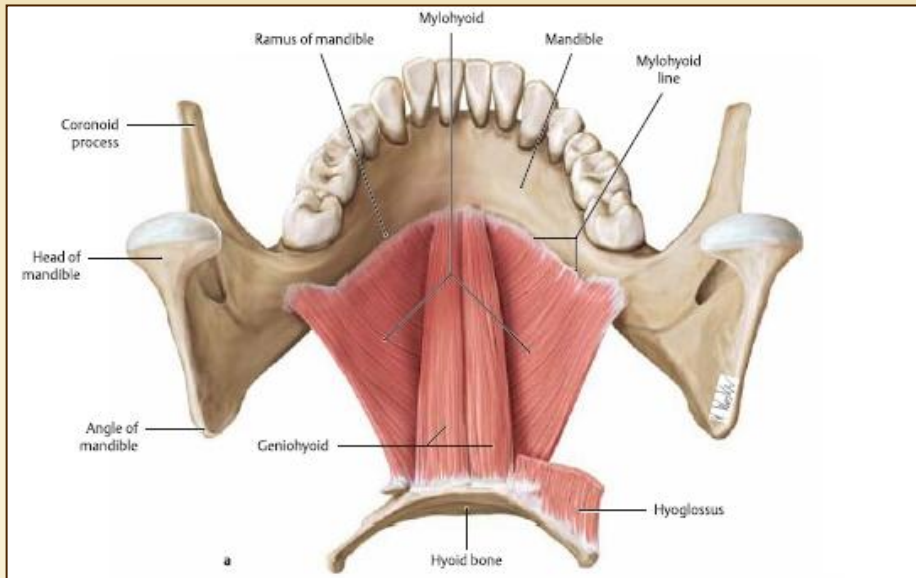
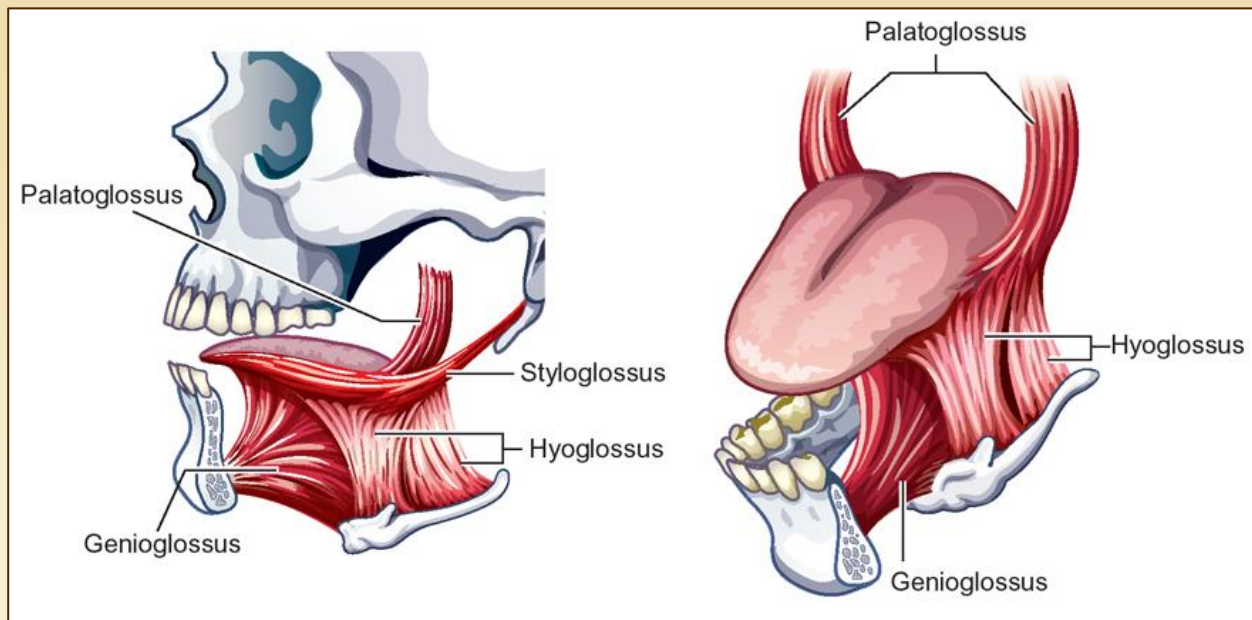


The floor of the oral cavity: oral diaphragm and the tongue

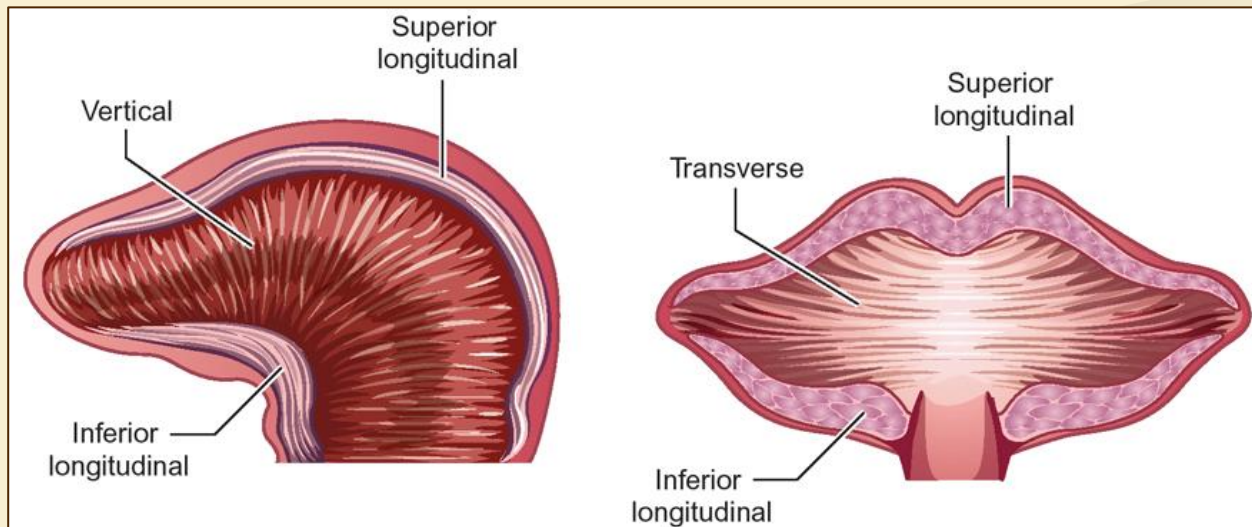


Tongue might be considered as a mucosa-covered muscular structure emerging from the oral floor.

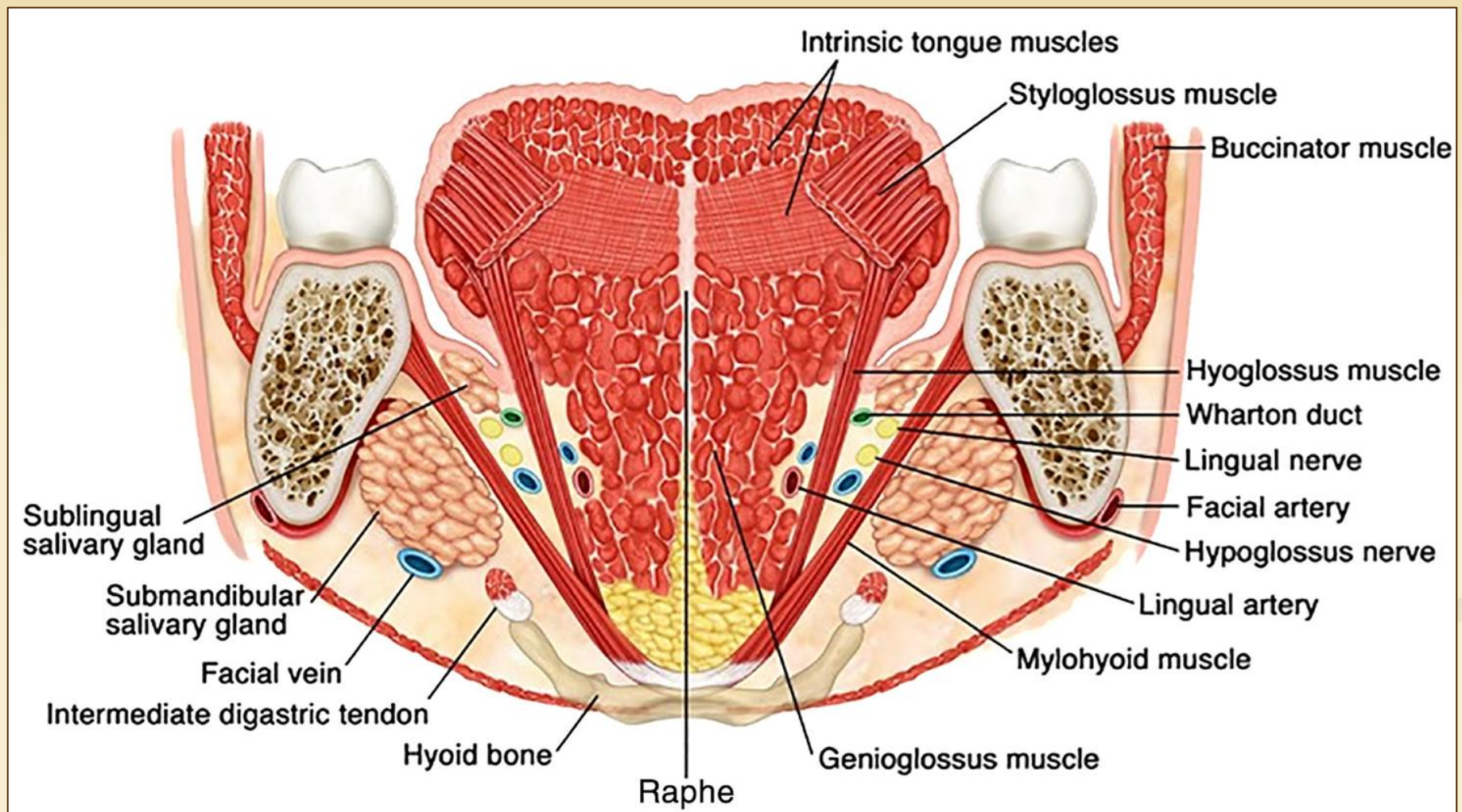
Dorsum linguae is the superior surface which is divided by the **sulcus terminalis** into two parts.



Extrinsic muscles determine the position of the tongue: Hyoglossus depresses, Palatoglossus elevates, Genioglossus protrudes, Styloglossus retracts the tongue.



Intrinsic muscles determine the shape of the tongue: Superior longitudinal, Inferior longitudinal, Vertical and Transverse muscles can be distinguished.



Hyoglossus muscle arises from the greater horn of the hyoid bone and projects into the lateral part of the tongue. It separates two spaces: the lateral and medial lingual sulci. **Lateral lingual sulcus:** sublingual gland, submandibular duct, lingual and hypoglossal nerves. **Medial lingual sulcus:** lingual artery.